

visible only to you, your friends or the general public. This kind of granular level control can be applied by you on fields such as age, e-mail ID, cell number and address—fields you may not want to reveal in totality. Remember, your profile is what others view when they browse for friends, so it can be the deciding factor in catching someone's interest.



The Orkut Home Page

The next thing you would want to do is upload your photos on the site, so that people can see how good you look! Similar to your profile, a photo definitely makes a difference in catching anyone's attention. You can even upload short videos of yours on the site. You have to upload the video to either Google Video or YouTube and specify the link to the video on Orkut.

To start interacting with people you can search for people and write in their scrapbooks, or else you can join a community on this site. There are all sorts of communities out there having people with common interests such as entertainment, sports, health, literature, technology, computers and what not. You may be slightly shy, but joining one of these could get you invites to events that these communities hold and you could start building a social circle.

You could also build your own social circle by inviting people to your own events. If you are a little rushed, when you search for people you can even mark them as your favourites or as your crushes and contact them later—similar to tagging or bookmarking the “important” ones.

If you are the bold kind, you could either directly message people or message them later after they have responded to your scraps. There is also a provision for blogging on the site and people can respond to your blogs and of course you can post replies to other blogs too.

Orkut is a must-sign-up-for site if you want to be visible in the online social networking circuit.